Evaluation Guidelines

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1 Introduction

The following guidelines describe the evaluation procedure used to assess the quality of implicit content reconstruction in argumentative texts. The evaluation is designed to compare manual reconstructions produced by human annotators and automatic reconstructions generated by language models, with the goal of measuring how suitable automatic approaches are for the task of reconstructing implicit meaning in dialogue-based argumentation.

In order to ensure an unbiased evaluation, all reconstructed texts are presented in an anonymous format. Annotators are not informed whether a given reconstruction was produced by a human or by an automatic system. This blind evaluation setup allows us to assess the performance of automatic reconstruction methods without introducing preference bias toward human-generated content.

The data used for evaluation consists of argumentative dialogues. Speaker turns are marked with the tags *speaker 1* and *speaker 2*. Each sentence in the dialogue is annotated with either *<Explicit> ... </Explicit>* or *<Implicit> ... </Implicit>* tags, indicating whether the meaning is fully expressed in the original text or whether some information must be inferred.

Both human annotators and language models were instructed to reconstruct **only the implicit instances**. For each implicit sentence, the missing information is added in the form of reconstructed segments enclosed in

<IMPLICIT_PREMISE> ... </IMPLICIT_PREMISE> or <IMPLICIT_CLAIM> ... </IMPLICIT_CLAIM> tags.

These tags are written in uppercase in order to make reconstructed instances easily distinguishable from the original text. The missing information can be added before or after the target (implicit) sentence.

It is important to note that the present evaluation does not aim to assess the correctness of argumentative component labeling (i.e., whether a segment should be considered a claim or a premise). Instead, the evaluation focuses exclusively on the quality of the reconstruction itself, that is, whether the added content appropriately, coherently, and adequately restores the implicit meaning of the original text.

2 Evaluation Criteria

The evaluation of reconstructed implicit content is based on two groups of criteria: **quantity** and **quality**.

The **quantity criteria** assess whether reconstruction introduces necessary information rather than redundant or repetitive information. The **quality criteria** evaluate how well the reconstructed information integrates with and improves the original text.

Each criterion is evaluated on a **three-point scale**, where 1 indicates poor performance, 2 indicates partial adequacy, and 3 indicates optimal performance.

Finally, a **preference criterion** allows annotators to indicate which reconstruction is overall superior when comparing multiple reconstructions.

2.1 Quantity

Redundancy

This criterion evaluates whether the reconstructed information is **necessary for understanding the text** or whether it simply **overloads the**

text by restating similar information that is already sufficiently expressed:

1 - Redundant

The text is redundant and the reconstruction adds unnecessary or obvious details. The reconstructed information does not contribute to understanding the text.

2 – Partially redundant

The text is partially redundant, but some reconstructed information is useful for better understanding.

3 – Non-redundant

The text is not redundant, the reconstructed information significantly improves understanding.

Examples:

1 - Redundant

<IMPLICIT_PREMISE>Romantic relationships are inherently the most meaningful form of connection between men and women.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> The highest form of relationship between men and women doomed to be romance. </Implicit>

2 – Partially redundant

<IMPLICIT_PREMISE>I assume relationships can be ranked by worth, with romance placed at the top.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> The highest form of relationship between men and women doomed to be romance. </Implicit>

3 – Non-redundant

<IMPLICIT_PREMISE>There are different "forms" or levels of relationships between men and women (e.g., friendship, partnership, mentorship), and these can be ranked.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> The highest form of relationship between men and women doomed to be romance. </Implicit>

Repetitiveness

This criterion evaluates whether the reconstructed content **simply repeats the original wording or meaning**, rather than introducing new inferred information:

1 – Repetitive

All reconstructed parts merely restate information already expressed in the original text without introducing any novelty.

2 – Partially repetitive

Some reconstructed parts repeat existing information, but other parts introduce novel inferred content.

3 – Non-repetitive

All reconstructed elements introduce new information that was implicit but not explicitly stated in the original text.

Examples:

1 – Repetitive

<IMPLICIT_PREMISE>A child's academic performance *is a direct reflection of their parents' efforts and guidance.*</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> A child who struggles in earnest or intentionally slacks off *is a direct reflection of parenting.* </Implicit>

2 – Partially repetitive

<IMPLICIT_PREMISE>*Parents are the primary influence* on a child's study habits, motivation, and discipline.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> A child who struggles in earnest or intentionally slacks off is *a direct reflection of parenting.* </Implicit>

3 – Non-repetitive

<IMPLICIT_PREMISE>Some children have real learning difficulties, some consider education not important failing at school purposely.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> A child who struggles in earnest or intentionally slacks off is a direct reflection of parenting. </Implicit>

2.2 Quality

Relevance

This criterion measures **the degree to which the reconstructed information is related to the meaning and argumentative structure of the original text**:

1 – Irrelevant

The reconstructed information is unrelated to the meaning of the original text.

2 – Partially relevant

The reconstructed information is somewhat related to the text, but it may introduce weakly connected information.

3 – Relevant

The reconstructed information directly relates to the text.

Examples:

1 – Irrelevant

<IMPLICIT_CLAIM>People aren't made rich — they're born rich</IMPLICIT_CLAIM> <Implicit> One of the largest predictors for success appears to be not being poor. How would you account for that? </Implicit>

2 – Partially relevant

<IMPLICIT_PREMISE>Socioeconomic status exerts a strong, independent influence on outcomes.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> One of the largest predictors for success appears to be not being poor. How would you account for that? </Implicit>

3 – Relevant

<Implicit> One of the largest predictors for success appears to be not being poor. How would you account for that? </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_CLAIM> What I mean is that poor people are majorly less successful.</IMPLICIT_CLAIM>

Fulfillment

This criterion evaluates whether the reconstruction **successfully fills informational gaps** left implicit in the original text:

1 – No fulfillment

The reconstruction does not fill the missing information necessary for understanding the implicit meaning.

2 – Partial fulfillment

The reconstruction fills some informational gaps, but the interpretation remains incomplete or still requires additional inference.

3 – Complete fulfillment

The reconstruction successfully fills the relevant informational gaps and makes the intended meaning clear.

Examples:

1 – No fulfillment

<Explicit> At some point, Man 's artificial economic system will necessarily collapse. </Explicit> <IMPLICIT_PREMISE>Without economic incentives, corporations will not continue their operations.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> When that happens, the corporations which produce and deliver food will no longer have an incentive to do so. </Implicit>

2 – Partial fulfillment

<Explicit> At some point, Man 's artificial economic system will necessarily collapse. </Explicit> <Implicit> When that happens, the corporations which produce and deliver food will no longer have an incentive to do so. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_PREMISE>Corporations only produce and deliver food when the economic system provides profit.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE>

3 – Complete fulfillment

<Explicit> At some point, Man 's artificial economic system will necessarily collapse. </Explicit> <Implicit> When that happens, the corporations which produce and deliver food will no longer have an incentive to do so. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_PREMISE>Corporations produce and distribute

goods primarily to earn profit within a functioning market; if the economic system collapses, profits and payments cannot be realized, thus, the usual external motivation fades.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE>

Adequacy

This criterion evaluates whether the reconstructed information is **plausible and appropriate given the context of the original text**. Adequacy focuses on whether the reconstruction represents a **reasonable interpretation** of what the speaker or writer likely intended:

1 – Inadequate

The reconstruction is not adequate, it is implausible and incompatible with the context.

2 – Partially adequate

The reconstruction is plausible but contains elements that are uncertain, debatable, or weakly supported by the text.

3 – Adequate

The reconstruction provides a plausible and contextually appropriate interpretation of the implicit meaning.

Examples:

1 – Inadequate

<Implicit> The cities will suffer great hunger and it will be the end of Man. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_CLAIM> The end of Man means that men will disappear but women will survive.</IMPLICIT_CLAIM>

2 – Partially adequate

<Implicit> The cities will suffer great hunger and it will be the end of Man. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_CLAIM>Cities may face serious food shortages.</IMPLICIT_CLAIM>

3 – Adequate

<Implicit> The cities will suffer great hunger and it will be the end of Man. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_CLAIM> The cessation of food production and delivery leads to mass starvation and human extinction. </IMPLICIT_CLAIM>

Coherence

This criterion evaluates how well the reconstructed elements **integrate with the original text and preserve its logical and linguistic flow**:

1 – Incoherent

The reconstructed elements disrupt the meaning or structure of the text and make the argument difficult to follow.

2 – Partially coherent

The reconstruction is generally understandable but introduces strange transitions or minor inconsistencies.

3 – Coherent

The reconstructed elements integrate naturally with the original text, producing a smooth and logically coherent interpretation.

Examples:

1 – Incoherent

<Implicit> Something like this will take decades or centuries and won't be applied evenly across the entire planet. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_CLAIM> However, societal changes always appear for good.</IMPLICIT_CLAIM> <Explicit> I don't see how it 's possible society couldn't adapt as the inevitability of a laborless civilization grows. </Explicit>

2 – Partially coherent

<Implicit> Something like this will take decades or centuries and won't be applied evenly across the entire planet. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_CLAIM>Large-scale societal changes occur gradually and unevenly.</IMPLICIT_CLAIM> <Explicit> I don't see how it 's possible society couldn't adapt as the inevitability of a laborless civilization grows. </Explicit>

3 – Coherent

<Implicit> Something like this will take decades or centuries and won't be applied evenly across the entire planet. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_CLAIM>It is totally impossible that the whole world crashes following the same wave

of crisis.</IMPLICIT_CLAIM> <Explicit> I don't see how it 's possible society couldn't adapt as the inevitability of a laborless civilization grows. </Explicit>

2.3 Preference

Since multiple reconstructions are evaluated for the same text, annotators are asked to indicate a **preference for the most appropriate reconstruction(s)**.

If one reconstruction is considered **overall superior**, the annotator assigns **one additional point** to that reconstruction. If several reconstructions are considered **equally optimal**, the **additional point** may be assigned to each of them.

3 Annotation Process

Annotators are asked to evaluate each reconstructed dialogue using the criteria described in the Section 2. The evaluation is performed at two levels. First, annotators evaluate the reconstructed dialogue as a whole, using the Quantity, Quality, and Preference criteria (Fig. 1). This global evaluation allows annotators to assess how well the reconstructed elements integrate into the overall dialogue and whether one reconstruction is preferable to another. Second, annotators evaluate each reconstructed implicit instance individually using the Quantity and Quality criteria (Fig. 2). This step focuses on the adequacy of the reconstruction for each target sentence where implicit meaning has been restored. To facilitate the annotation process, all implicit instances are listed separately after the full dialogue, together with their corresponding target sentences. This format allows annotators to locate the reconstructed segments in the dialogue and to evaluate them easier, while still having access to the full context when needed.

Annotation example:

Id2

speaker1: <IMPLICIT_PREMISE>Democracy implies that the country is ruled by its population through representatives elected by this population.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <IMPLICIT_PREMISE>Meanwhile, a democracy ensures certain freedoms, such as freedom of expression, associations, religion etc.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> America is not a democracy. </Implicit> <Implicit> Really though. There is an unchecked organization that spies on them 24/7 without consent. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_PREMISE>The U.S. allows intelligence agencies to conduct mass surveillance of its citizens without their informed consent or effective oversight.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> The US has given itself license to detain and torture citizens with no trial. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_PREMISE>The government massively violates due process and human rights, which contradicts the principles of democracy and the rule of law.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> The energy laws in that country allow corporations to drill where they please and, as a result, poison who they please. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_PREMISE>U.S. energy regulations are shaped in ways that fossil fuel companies may extract resources anywhere, even if the local population is harmed by air, water or land pollution.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> American citizens have clearly been lied to in many situations. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_PREMISE> For instance, the progress of the Vietnam War was misrepresented and revealed only after the leakage of the Pentagon Papers, or the scale of domestic surveillance that was again revealed only due to the leakage of documents from Edward Snowden.< </IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> These lies have led to events like the second gulf war. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_PREMISE>The invasion of Iraq in 2003 (the second Gulf War or the Iraq War) was justified by the fact that Iraq had weapons of mass destruction, but their existence has never been proven.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> Not to mention the completely unregulated financial system. </Implicit> <IMPLICIT_CLAIM>A lack of regulation over financial institutions allows the wealthy to operate without democratic control, contributing to inequality, instability, and public harm.</IMPLICIT_CLAIM> <Explicit> Honestly, none of these things have been democratically voted for, so why are Americans so deluded about this? </Explicit> <Explicit> It 's not a free, democratic society by any means. It's clearly an oligarchy. </Explicit> speaker2: <Explicit> A democracy is not necessarily a functional, benevolent government, nor is a democracy necessarily free. </Explicit> <Explicit> The USA was intended to be a federal republic, a republic being a form of indirect democracy. </Explicit> <Explicit> To see if it actually *is* one (at least the\" republic\" part), we just need to answer a few simple questions. </Explicit> <Explicit> Is political power in the US held by elected officials? </Explicit> <Explicit> Are those officials elected in free and fair democratic elections? </Explicit> <Explicit> The answer to both of those questions is unambiguously\" yes.\" </Explicit> <Explicit> The domestic spying, the secret courts, the torture, the corporate favoritism, the environmental destruction, the lies, the unjustified wars, the unregulated financial system ... all of those are things instituted or approved by our democratically elected officials, fully within the scope of power ceded to them by the constitution. </Explicit> <Explicit> And we continue to vote those who do these things into office in free and fair elections, time and time again, without fail. </Explicit> <Explicit> You can argue, perhaps successfully, that the US is a fascist, un-free state, but it remains by definition a democratic one. </Explicit> speaker1: <Explicit> Fair enough haha. This is the best argument I 've seen here </Explicit> <Implicit> but how can you have truly fair elections if things like superpacs exist? </Implicit>

Figure 1: Dialogue example

<IMPLICIT_PREMISE>A country where an unchecked organization spies on its citizens without consent is not a democracy.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> Really though. There is an unchecked organization that spies on them 24/7 without consent. </Implicit>
IMPLICIT_PREMISE>A country that detains and tortures its citizens without trial is not a democracy.</IMPLICIT_PREMISE> <Implicit> The US has given itself license to detain and torture citizens with no trial. </Implicit>

Figure 2: Reconstruction + target sentence